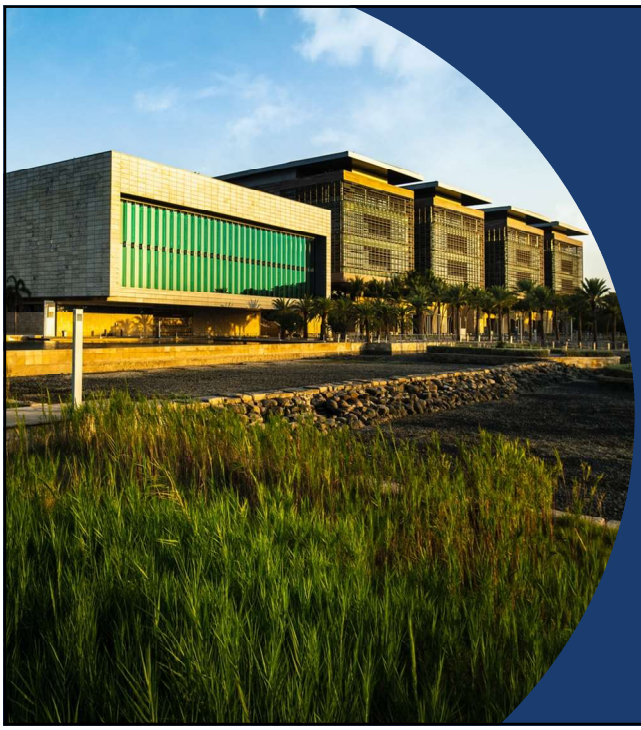

جامعة الملك عبدالله للعلوم والتقنية
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology

KSA UNIVERSITIES

DEVELOPING ACADEMIC LEADERS PROGRAM,

Day 1

Leading Self, Leading Others and Developing High Performing Teams

Professor Jonathan Grant
Dr Tom Kennie &
Dr Sara Hurley

أكاديمية كاوست
KAUST ACADEMY

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DAY 1 – MONDAY 30TH MARCH - pm

جامعة الملك عبدالله للعلوم والتقنية
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01 Developing High Performing Teams

02 Lessons from Practice: Team Exercise

03 High Performing Teamworking: Conceptual Frameworks

04 Values, Behaviours and Developing a Team Charter

05 BREAK

06 Developing High Performing *Research Teams*: What Does the Research Suggest?

07 Briefing on Visits

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Words, words words……

- COMMITTEE
- GROUP
- BOARD
- CABINET
- TEAM
- HIGH PERFORMING TEAM
- VCE, VCEG, SLT, SLT+, SMT, UEG, ILT, DRG, MMM
- *WHAT CHARACTERISES THE DIFFERENCES?*

3

'CHECK-IN'

What captures your sense of where your team is at the moment? and why?

1 ⟷ 10

A bunch of (high performing) individuals who meet

A committee or group – not a team

Already a high performing team

4

Or is it more like…

'Eight people going backward as fast as they can, without talking to each other, steered by the one person who can't row'

BUT they have:

- **Complete confidence in each other,**
- **A very high level of synchronicity**
- **A real shared passion for the same goal, and**
- ***total confidence in the one person who can't or who isn't currently rowing!***

5

Or does it feel sometimes like this…..

- ***four people who are rowing their hearts out,***
- ***two who seem to be taking in the scenery, and***
- ***two who, on occasions, seem to be trying to sink the boat!."***

6

Practice to Inform Theories
Team Leadership in Action

7

TEAM WORKING 101
Summary of Some Key Lessons for Exercise

- Importance of all team members having a clear understanding of the task
- All members clear of their role – and a good match between role and skills of each team member
- Clear communication
- The importance of asking good questions
- The importance of shared team leadership
- The importance of checking assumptions
- Learning and adapting as new information becomes available to the team
- ....

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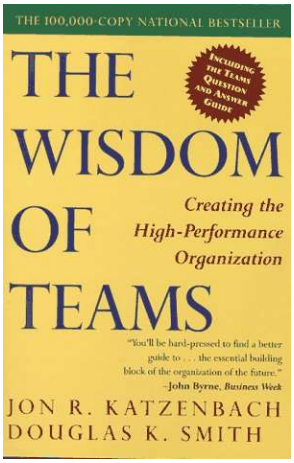
Concepts - *Teams, Teamworking & High Performing Teamworking*



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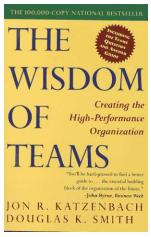
ONE RULE OF FIVE

People working together to achieve a common goal
Your 'day job' purpose as a team – delivering your plans and associated KPIs

A (real team) is a *small number* of people *with complementary skills* who are committed to a *common purpose, agreed performance goals* and an approach, for which they hold themselves *mutually accountable*.



Katzenbach, J. R., & Smith, D. K. (2003). *The wisdom of teams: Creating the high performance organizations.* New York: Collins Business.

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Mutual Accountability

- *'I have no idea what you mean Tom, of course we are all collectively accountable'*
- **Collective and mutual accountability are different**
- **How might you demonstrate and exemplify mutual accountability?**
- **Vision – by actively promoting and being an advocate of your strategy and strategic priorities**
- **Valuing (through your behaviour as set out in your team charter)**
- **Validating (each other) through support for each others agenda's**
- **Vocalising a coherent and consistent voice about the *team's* agenda**

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High Performing Executive Teams in Higher Education

ONE RULE OF SIX

(**Source**: Steve Woodfield & Tom Kennie (2007) Top Team Structures in UK Higher Education Institutions: Composition, Challenges, and Changes, Tertiary Education and Management, 13:4, 331-348, DOI: 10.1080/13583880701535521)

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(**Source**: A Twitter post from History Photographed - A balancing act on the chimney of a twenty-two-story building in New York, c. 1920s)

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Clear Personal Roles & Individual Accountabilities

8

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NAME.....

	PRIORITY	PEOPLE *(Who on the team and beyond are most critical to ensure delivery?, no more than 4 ..)*	POTENTIAL PRESSURE POINT *(possible issue I anticipate might impact on delivery and team should be aware of- plus roughly month when it might arise?)*
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

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A Collective Focus on Shared Ways of Working
Clear Personal Roles & Individual Accountabilities
Clear Team Structure & Shared Mutual Accountabilities

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WATERLOO

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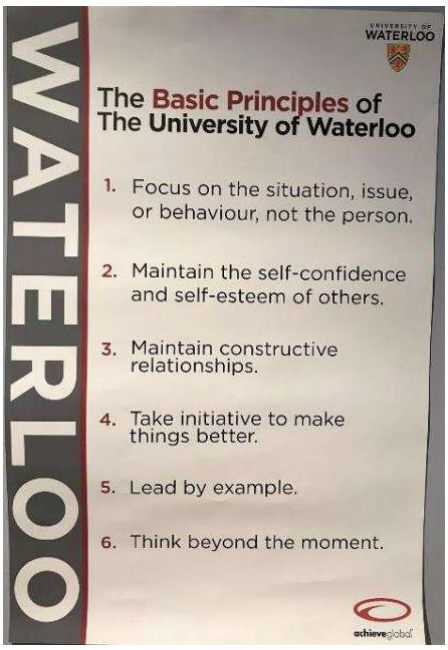

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Our Guiding Principles – KAUST Strategic Initiatives

These six principles are the way we work—with each other and with the wider university community. They are our compass and our commitment.

1 — Show not Tell

We demonstrate our values through our actions — modeling the standards we expect expect from others.

2 — Say it clearly, Say it kindly

We communicate openly and honestly, with respect and kindness — listening attentively and building trust and clarity in everything we do.

3 — Own it, together

We proactively take responsibility for our work and own our mistakes — stepping in to support one another.

4 — Bend, don't break

We stay adaptable and resilient — adjusting together when things change without losing momentum.

5 — Row in the same direction

We align on goals and use each other's strengths — moving forward together as one team.

6 — Have fun

We maintain positivity, model it, deliver with focus and purpose, and we take fun seriously! — celebrating wins, laughing together, and keeping the balance real.

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Bringing the Charter to Life

We embed our principles into our daily work through:

Meetings
Start with a principles spotlight, close with reflections

Behaviors
"Me / You / Us" commitments

Onboarding
Introduce the charter to every new team colleague

Feedback & Recognition
Use principles to guide feedback and celebrate colleagues

Visibility & Culture
Keep it present in our space and protect balance through connection

Review
Revisit quarterly, refresh annually

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High Performing Teamworking

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Trust, Psychological Safety and Collegial Team Spirit

'I've got your back'

'We've got your back'

'We've got each others back'

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ONE MORE RULE OF FIVE

The five keys to a successful Google team

JULIA ROZOVSKY, ANALYST, GOOGLE PEOPLE OPERATIONS | NOVEMBER 17, 2015

Pod. Work group. Committee. Autonomous collective. Whatever you call it, you're part of one at Google and probably wherever you work: a team. So if we know what makes managers great, why don't we know what makes a team great?

A group of us in Google's People Operations (what we call HR) set out to answer this

(**Source**: Rozovsky, J. (2015 November). *The five keys to a successful Google team* in re:Work)

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ONE MORE RULE OF FIVE

(**Source**: Rozovsky, J. (2015 November). *The five keys to a successful Google team* in re:Work)

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PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

WHEN YOU HAVE IT:	*WHEN YOU DON'T:*
See mistakes as opportunities to learn	*See mistakes as threats to your career*
Willing to take risks and fail	*Unwilling to rock the boat*
Speaking your mind in meetings	*Keeping your ideas to yourself*
Openly sharing your struggles	*Only touting your strengths*
Trust in your teammates and supervisors	*Fear of your teammates and supervisors*
Sticking your neck out	*Having it chopped off*

ranmore

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Professor Atul Gwande

Music in the operating theatre developing a Spotify playlist

27

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Team Playlist
Understanding us…

- Pick your desert island disk – a piece of music which you like and is important to you.
- What's the back story to the track you've selected.
- Why did you select this particular track?
- In pairs share your stories
- Report back briefly a memorable insight about your partner which emerged from the stories which you shared.

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HIGH PERFORMING TEAMWORKING

High Performing Team Working
Which do you sense needs attention/rebalancing?

1.	Operational	v	Strategic
2.	Internal focus	v	External focus
3.	Short term	v	Long term
4.	Reporting matters	v	Decision matters
5.	Representing others	v	Acting jointly
6.	My agenda	v	Our agenda
7.	Clear boundaries	v	Blurred boundaries
8.	Competing	v	Collaborating
9.	Individual decisions	v	Team decisions
10.	Personal accountabilities	v	Mutual accountabilities

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Thank you!
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